

SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital — Patient Support, Feedback & Complaint Procedure

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1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Purpose

Patient feedback is the cornerstone of clinical excellence and service refinement at SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital. This guide defines official avenues for voicing patient feedback, outlines accessible support services, and establishes an objective, transparent, and structured standard operating procedure for registering, investigating, and resolving complaints and grievances.

1.2 Scope

This procedure applies to all services provided across outpatient clinics, inpatient wards, emergency rooms, surgical suites, diagnostic facilities, billing counters, pharmacies, parking, housekeeping, and dietary services at SmartCare Hospital.

2. Patient Support & Assistance Services

SmartCare Hospital operates specialized support desks to assist patients and families throughout their healthcare journey:

- **Central Information & Helpdesk (Ground Floor Atrium):** General inquiries, campus directions, wheelchair dispatches, doctor clinic schedules, and visitor passes.
 - **Patient Relations & Hospitality Desk (Ground Floor Wing B):** Personalized guidance for out-of-town patients, long-stay inpatient advocacy, and special assistance for senior citizens.
 - **TPA & Insurance Coordination Desk (Ground Floor Wing B):** Guidance on cashless pre-authorization, claim tracking, and query resolution.
 - **Medical Social Work & Financial Aid Desk (Level 1 Administrative Block):** Assistance for economically disadvantaged patients, charity trust applications, and counseling.
 - **Accessibility & Special Needs Support:** Wheelchair escort services, tactile floor paths for the visually impaired, and sign-language communication support.
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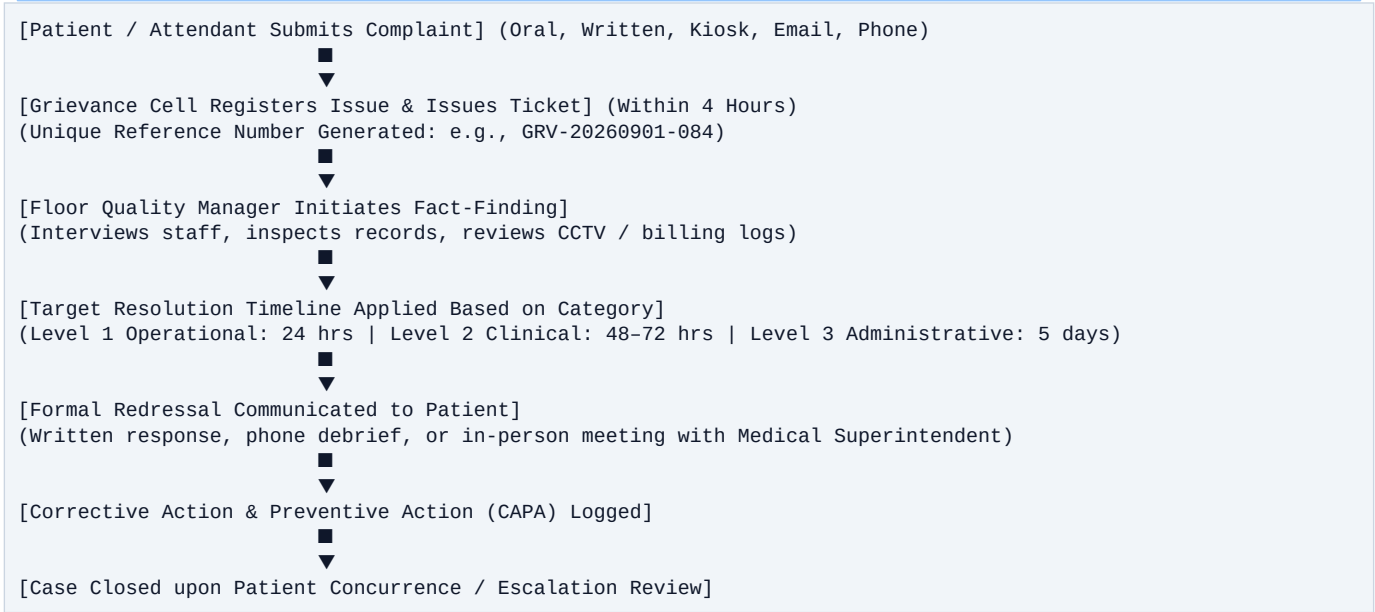
3. Avenues for Patient Feedback & Compliments

Patients and family members are invited to share their experiences and commend outstanding healthcare providers through multiple convenient channels:

1. **Digital Bedside & OPD Feedback Kiosks:** Touchscreen tablets installed in all outpatient waiting lounges and delivered to inpatient rooms on the day of discharge.
2. **Online Feedback Portal:** Accessible 24/7 at <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/feedback>.

- 3. **Automated Post-Visit SMS / WhatsApp Survey:** Sent within 24 hours of OPD consultation or inpatient discharge containing a quick 5-question Net Promoter Score (NPS) survey.
- 4. **Physical Feedback Forms:** Available in all clinic reception areas, inpatient nursing stations, and drop boxes located next to every elevator bank.

4. Formal Grievance & Complaint Redressal Process



5. Complaint Severity Categories & Resolution Timelines

SmartCare Hospital categorizes grievances into four distinct severity levels with strict Service Level Agreements (SLAs):

Severity Category	Description & Nature of Grievances	Investigating Authority	Target Resolution SLA
Category A: Service & Facility	Room air conditioning, housekeeping, noise levels, dietary delays, parking issues, elevator wait times.	Floor Operations Supervisor & Facilities Head	Within 4 to 12 Hours
Category B: Administrative & Billing	Extended billing wait times, billing calculation disputes, TPA delay, appointment token delays.	Billing Manager & Patient Experience Head	Within 24 Hours
Category C: Staff Conduct & Communication	Perceived discourtesy, lack of nursing responsiveness, communication gaps, inadequate explanation by staff.	Nursing Superintendent & Head of Human Resources	Within 24 to 48 Hours
Category D: Clinical Care & Medical Protocols	Disagreements regarding medical treatment, nursing procedures, diagnostic discrepancies, medication delays.	Medical Superintendent & Hospital Quality Board	Within 48 to 72 Hours

6. Escalation Matrix

If a patient or family member is dissatisfied with the resolution provided by the initial investigating officer, the grievance can be escalated through the following formal hierarchy:

- **Level 1 (Initial Contact):** Floor Patient Relations Executive / Ward Nursing Supervisor.
- **Level 2 (Departmental Review):** Head of Patient Experience & Quality Assurance (Ext. 5566).
- **Level 3 (Senior Leadership):** Medical Superintendent & Chief Operating Officer (Email: coo@smartcarehospital-demo.org).
- **Level 4 (Institutional Appellate Board):** Chief Executive Officer & Hospital Ethics Ombudsman.

7. Accessibility Services & Vulnerable Patient Support

SmartCare Multispecialty Hospital guarantees dedicated equity and accessibility accommodations:

- **Senior Citizens (Age 65+):** Dedicated registration line (Counter 1), prioritized token allocation, and complimentary wheelchair escort.
- **Differently-Abled Individuals:** Ramp access at all gates, braille-equipped elevators, wide-door handicap restrooms, and assistive listening devices.
- **Language Interpretation:** Real-time on-campus translation support for Telugu, Hindi, Urdu, English, Marathi, and Kannada. International patient support available via the International Desk.
- **Financial Hardship Support:** Inability to pay is referred directly to the Medical Social Work Department for assessment of concessions, charitable aid, or flexible installment planning.

8. RAG Knowledge Search & Question Triggers

- **Trigger Queries:** "How do I complain about a rude nurse / doctor?", "Where is the patient help desk?", "Who do I talk to about billing problems?", "How long does a complaint take to resolve?", "Can I submit an anonymous complaint?", "Is wheelchair assistance available for elderly patients?", "Where do I submit feedback?"
- **Standardized Fact Base:** Patient Relations desk is on Ground Floor Wing B. Complaints can be submitted via portal, email (grievances@smartcarehospital-demo.org), or phone (+91-40-6999-5566). Category A resolved in 4–12 hrs; Category B in 24 hrs; Clinical complaints in 48–72 hrs. Escalation to Medical Superintendent available.

9. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: How can I register a formal complaint about my experience at SmartCare Hospital?

A: You can register a complaint by calling the Grievance Cell at +91-40-6999-5566, emailing grievances@smartcarehospital-demo.org, submitting a digital ticket at <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/complaints>, or meeting the Patient Relations Executive in Ground Floor Wing B.

Q2: What information will I receive after submitting a complaint?

A: You will immediately receive an official acknowledgement via SMS and email containing your unique Grievance Ticket Number (e.g., GRV-20260901-084) and the name of the assigned investigating officer.

Q3: How long does it take for the hospital to resolve a complaint?

A: Facility and housekeeping issues are resolved within 4 to 12 hours. Billing and administrative issues are resolved within 24 hours. In-depth clinical or staff conduct reviews are completed within 48 to 72 hours.

Q4: Can I submit a complaint anonymously?

A: Yes. You can place an anonymous written complaint in the suggestion boxes located near the elevators on every floor, or submit an online feedback form without providing your name or contact information.

Q5: What happens if an anonymous complaint is submitted?

A: Anonymous complaints are reviewed weekly by the Hospital Quality and Safety Committee. However, specific individual resolution cannot be communicated back to you without contact information.

Q6: What should I do if my room air conditioner or television is not working during my hospital stay?

A: Press your nurse call bell or dial Extension 1066 from your room phone. A facilities maintenance technician will visit your room within 30 minutes to repair or replace the equipment.

Q7: Who should I contact if I feel a nurse or staff member spoke to me disrespectfully?

A: Ask to speak directly with the Floor Nursing Supervisor or call the Patient Experience Manager at +91-40-6999-5566. An immediate on-site intervention will be conducted.

Q8: Can I complain about the quality or taste of the hospital food?

A: Yes. Contact the Dietary Supervisor at Extension 1055. A clinical dietician will visit your room to evaluate the food, adjust seasoning within your clinical dietary restrictions, or replace the meal.

Q9: What should I do if I am dissatisfied with the resolution of my complaint?

A: You can escalate your complaint to Level 3 by emailing the Medical Superintendent directly at medicalsuperintendent@smartcarehospital-demo.org, quoting your ticket reference number.

Q10: Is there wheelchair assistance available when I arrive at the hospital?

A: Yes. Dedicated wheelchair attendants are stationed 24 hours a day at the Main Atrium Entrance (Gate 2) and Emergency Entrance (Gate 1) free of charge.

Q11: How do I express my appreciation or praise for a doctor or nurse who gave excellent care?

A: You can submit a compliment through our digital feedback kiosks, write a commendation on a physical feedback form, or post a review on the SmartCare Patient Portal. Your compliments are shared with the staff member and added to their professional excellence record.

Q12: Can I get language translation support if I only speak Hindi or Kannada?

A: Yes. Our Patient Relations Desk provides translators for Hindi, Telugu, Urdu, Kannada, and Marathi. Contact the Helpdesk or call Extension 1010.

Q13: Does SmartCare have special services for senior citizens?

A: Yes. Patients aged 65 and above receive priority registration at Counter 1, dedicated seating in waiting lounges, complimentary wheelchair escort, and expedited pharmacy billing.

Q14: How does the hospital ensure that complaints do not negatively affect my medical treatment?

A: SmartCare enforces a strict Non-Retaliation Policy. The Grievance Cell operates independently of clinical treating teams, ensuring your right to voice concerns without any impact on clinical care quality.

Q15: What steps does the hospital take after investigating a complaint?

A: When a complaint is verified, the hospital implements Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA), which may include staff counseling, workflow modifications, equipment replacement, or procedural retraining.

Q16: Can I request a change of treating doctor if I am not satisfied with my current consultant?

A: Yes. You have the right to request another qualified consultant within the same specialty. Contact the Medical Superintendent's office or Floor Nurse Manager to facilitate a smooth clinical handover.

Q17: How can I dispute an extended waiting time at the outpatient clinic?

A: Report the delay to the floor clinic coordinator. If a doctor is delayed due to an emergency surgery, you will be informed immediately and offered the option to consult an associate doctor or reschedule at priority.

Q18: What is the role of the Patient Relations Executive?

A: Patient Relations Executives act as neutral patient advocates, facilitating communication, resolving bedside grievances, explaining hospital policies, and ensuring patient comfort throughout the visit.

Q19: Can a family member file a complaint on behalf of a patient?

A: Yes, an immediate family member or authorized attendant can lodge a complaint by quoting the patient's UHID and room/appointment number.

Q20: What should I do if I suspect my personal belongings were stolen in the hospital?

A: Report the incident immediately to the Central Security Desk on Ground Floor Wing A or call Extension 1044. Security officers will review CCTV footage and coordinate with local law enforcement if necessary.

Q21: Can I request special food accommodations for religious or dietary preferences?

A: Yes. The Dietary Department provides pure vegetarian, Jain, low-sodium, diabetic, and gluten-free meals. Please inform the nursing staff during admission.

Q22: How can I participate in the SmartCare Patient Advisory Panel?

A: Former patients and caregivers interested in contributing to hospital service improvements can apply to join our quarterly Patient & Family Advisory Council by emailing advocacy@smartcarehospital-demo.org.

Q23: Are feedback surveys reviewed by hospital senior leadership?

A: Yes. Patient feedback scores and Net Promoter Scores (NPS) are reviewed weekly by the Chief Executive Officer and Department Heads to drive systemic quality improvements.

Q24: What assistance is provided to patients from outside Hyderabad or international patients?

A: The International & Domestic Guest Services Desk provides assistance with airport transfers, local hotel accommodations, currency exchange guidance, and visa medical documentation.

Q25: What is the contact number to speak directly with the Patient Experience Head?

A: You can reach the Office of the Head of Patient Experience directly at **+91-40-6999-5566** during business hours (Monday–Saturday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM).

10. Official Contact Directory

- **Central Patient Relations & Grievance Cell:** Ground Floor, Wing B
- **Direct Phone:** +91-40-6999-5566 / +91-40-6999-5567
- **Grievance Helpline (WhatsApp):** +91-40-6999-5500
- **Email:** grievances@smartcarehospital-demo.org / feedback@smartcarehospital-demo.org
- **Online Grievance Submission:** <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/complaints>
- **Operating Hours:** Dedicated support available Monday through Saturday, 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM. (Emergency concerns handled 24/7 by the Night Administrator).